

Section 15.2 Community and tradition

Students will be required to: demonstrate knowledge and understanding of the specification; express their own responses to the issues and questions raised by the specification using reasons and evidence; evaluate alternative points of view about these issues and questions.

Key words — Arahant, bhikku, bhikkuni, bodhi tree, Buddha, dhamma, Dhammapada, Lotus Sutra, Mahayana, sangha, Theravada, Zen

- The events in the life of the Buddha which show the path to enlightenment (the four sights, ascetic practices, meditation under the bodhi tree).
- The importance of the Buddha's teachings on the dhamma.
- The importance of the Buddha's founding of the sangha.
- The importance of the Buddha's death and parinibbana.
- The distinctive features of Theravada Buddhism.
- The distinctive features of Mahayana Buddhism.
- The distinctive features of Vajrayana Buddhism.
- The distinctive features of Zen Buddhism.
- The distinctive features of the Western Buddhist Order.
- The main features of a Theravada vihara and the reasons for them.
- The main features of a Mahayana vihara and the reasons for them.